Ideation Phase
Empathize & Discover

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Project Name	flightfinder: navigating your air travel options
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas:

Gemini said

An Empathy Map Canvas is a collaborative tool used to gain a deeper insight into your customers. For a flight booking app, it shifts the focus from "what" the user is doing to "why" they are doing it, helping your team design a more human-centric interface.

The Matter: Six Core Quadrants

1. Who are we empathizing with? Identify the specific user (e.g., a budget-conscious student or a stressed business traveler). Define their situation—are they booking a dream vacation or a last-minute emergency flight? Their emotional state will dictate how you design your UI.

2. What do they need to DO? Define the goal. They need to compare prices without feeling cheated, select a seat with extra legroom, or complete a booking in under three minutes while on a moving train. What is the one "win" they need from your app today?

3. What do they SEE? Describe their environment. They see competing ads on Google, confusing "low-cost" airline websites with hidden fees, and perhaps social media posts of friends traveling. They are bombarded with visual noise and high-pressure sales tactics like "only 2 seats left!"

4. What do they SAY and DO? Think about their outward behavior. They might say, "I just want the final price upfront," or they might search for "cheap flights" on multiple tabs. Their actions include refreshing pages to check for price drops and reading fine-print reviews about baggage allowances.

5. What do they HEAR? Consider the influence of others. They hear friends complaining about canceled flights, coworkers praising a specific travel app for its simplicity, and family members worrying about safety or hidden costs. These external voices create the "trust barrier" your app must overcome.

6. What do they THINK and FEEL? (Pains & Gains) This is the heart of the map.

- **Pains: Fear of overpaying, anxiety about missing a connection, or frustration with a slow checkout.**
- **Gains: The relief of a "Price Match Guarantee," the excitement of a confirmed booking, and the satisfaction of a clean, ad-free interface.**

To deepen your **Empathy Map**, you need to look at the "Internal Monologue" and the "Hidden Friction" that occurs during a flight booking. This moves beyond basic observations into the psychological state of your user.

1. The Internal Monologue (Think & Feel)

This section captures the "Unspoken Doubts" a user has while using your app. They aren't just thinking about a destination; they are performing a risk assessment.

- **The "Am I Being Scammed?" Filter:** In an era of hidden fees, users are constantly thinking, *"Is this the final price, or will they add a 'convenience fee' at the very last second?"* * **The Fear of Commitment:** Booking a flight is a high-stakes financial decision. They feel the pressure of the "Non-Refundable" tag. Your map should capture this anxiety—the moment of hesitation before clicking "Pay Now."
- **The Digital Fatigue:** They are likely feeling overwhelmed by open tabs. They think, *"I just want one app that actually remembers my passport details so I don't have to get up and find my bag."*

2. The Influence Environment (Hear)

What a user "hears" isn't just literal sound—it's the "Social Proof" and market reputation that shapes their expectations.

- **The "Horror Story" Echo:** They hear stories about 12-hour delays and lost luggage. This makes them look for "Travel Insurance" or "Refund Protection" icons.
- **The Recommendation Loop:** They hear from tech-savvy friends that "App X has a better UI than App Y." They are listening for validation that your platform is the modern standard, not a legacy system.

3. The Physical Context (Do & See)

This focuses on the **User's Physical Reality** while interacting with your code.

- **The "On-the-Go" Reality:** Are they seeing your app on a cracked phone screen while rushing through an airport? This dictates your button size and contrast ratios.
- **The Comparison Loop:** They see "Price Match" badges on other sites. If they don't see one on yours, they hear a "warning bell" in their head that they might be overpaying.
- **The Distraction Factor:** They see notifications from other apps popping up. Your app's "Job" is to be so fast and intuitive that they finish the booking before a WhatsApp message distracts them.

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Explore

4. The "Pains" and "Gains" (The Bottom Line)

- **Pains (The Friction):** The pain of entering credit card details for the 5th time; the frustration of a "Session Expired" popup; the fear of clicking the "Back" button and losing all search data.
- **Gains (The Delight):** The "Aha!" moment when they see a price-graph showing today is the cheapest day to fly; the relief of a "Saved Traveler" profile that auto-fills their data; the joy of a visually clear seat-selection map.